Bucket truck maintenance schedule

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For bucket trucks and aerial lift trucks used by tree crews. There are really two machines here: the aerial device, which has its own inspection rules, and the truck underneath it, which gets a severe-duty schedule because the boom runs on engine hours with no miles.

Based on OSHA's aerial lift rules, the ANSI/SAIA A92.2 standard and manufacturer guidance. Your lift's manual and your employer's or utility's rules come first.

Every day, before use

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Test the lift controls	Daily, before use	Required by OSHA	
Walk around the boom and bucket	Daily	Boom, liner, hoses, fittings, leveling, decals	
Outriggers and interlocks work	Daily		
Insulated booms: look for cracks, dirt, bird nests	Daily	Nests show up inside booms in spring	
Fall protection attached to the boom or bucket	Every use	Required by OSHA; never tie off to the tree or a pole	
Brakes set, outriggers on pads, wheels chocked on a slope	Every setup	Required by OSHA	
Boom cradled and outriggers stowed before driving	Every move	Required by OSHA	

Frequent (daily to monthly)

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Frequent inspection of the aerial device	Daily to monthly	How often depends on use and how hard it works	

Yearly (periodic)

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Periodic inspection by a qualified person	At least yearly	Rotation bearing bolts, backlash, leveling chains, winch line, under the liner	
Dielectric test, insulated booms	At least yearly	Also after repairs to the insulating section or contact with power lines	
Hydraulic oil and filter	Per your manual	Sooner with heavy use or bad weather	

The truck underneath

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Engine service on the severe schedule	By miles or engine hours	One hour of idle or PTO counts as about 25 to 33 miles for oil life	
Chassis service	Per your manual	See the dump truck and diesel pickup schedules	

Required by code? OSHA requires the daily control test, fall protection, the setup rules and the boom-stowed-before-driving rule. The yearly periodic inspection and dielectric test come from the ANSI/SAIA A92.2 standard, which is voluntary unless your employer, insurer or a utility contract requires it, and many line-clearance contracts do, often more often than yearly. An insulated boom that has gone more than 12 months without a dielectric test shouldn't be trusted as insulated. Recent editions of the standard also call for a major structural inspection after about 15 years in service. A non-insulated boom must never be treated as insulated near power lines.

Service log: bucket truck

Machine / unit: _____ Make & model: _____

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DATE	HOURS / MILES	WORK DONE	PARTS USED	INITIALS